

Iowa ARNG Child and Youth Program Data Trends Report

Year over year program and social media analysis

This report summarizes the annual program totals available for FY20 through FY26 and Facebook records available from 2011 through September 16, 2026. The strongest combined finding is that FY25 generated substantially greater program attendance while recent Facebook content also reached its best recorded engagement levels.

189% FY25 ATTENDANCE INCREASE	82.1 FY25 ATTENDEES PER EVENT	31.7% 2025 ENGAGEMENT INCREASE	141 FACEBOOK POSTS IN 2025
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Executive findings

FY25 was the strongest attendance year. Attendance increased from 2,213 in FY24 to 6,401 in FY25. The number of events rose from 53 to 78, but attendance grew much faster than event count. This raised average attendance from 41.8 to 82.1 participants per event.

The program has generally delivered fewer but larger events. Event count declined from 122 in FY20 to 53 in FY24. Average attendance nevertheless reached 73.0 in FY22 and 71.1 in FY23. The pattern indicates increased reach per event, although it does not by itself measure participant experience or outcomes.

Facebook engagement improved after 2024. Total engagement rose 31.7 percent in 2025 while posting volume increased only 6.8 percent. Engagement per post increased from 10.6 to 13.1, indicating that the improvement was not explained by posting frequency alone.

2026 social performance remains strong. Through September 16, the page recorded 122 posts and 1,802 engagements. That is already 97 percent of the engagement recorded during all of 2025, with average engagement at 14.8 per post.

FY26 shows a different delivery pattern. The current record includes 66 completed or reporting-complete events and 363.5 program hours, but attendance is 1,755. Compared with FY25, the program recorded 15 percent fewer events, 34 percent more hours, and 73 percent lower attendance. The figures point to smaller or more time-intensive programming, but event-level review is needed before attributing a cause.

Annual program performance

The annual totals show a reduction in event volume through FY24 followed by a strong FY25 recovery. Attendance per event is the clearest measure of that shift because it separates reach from the number of scheduled activities.

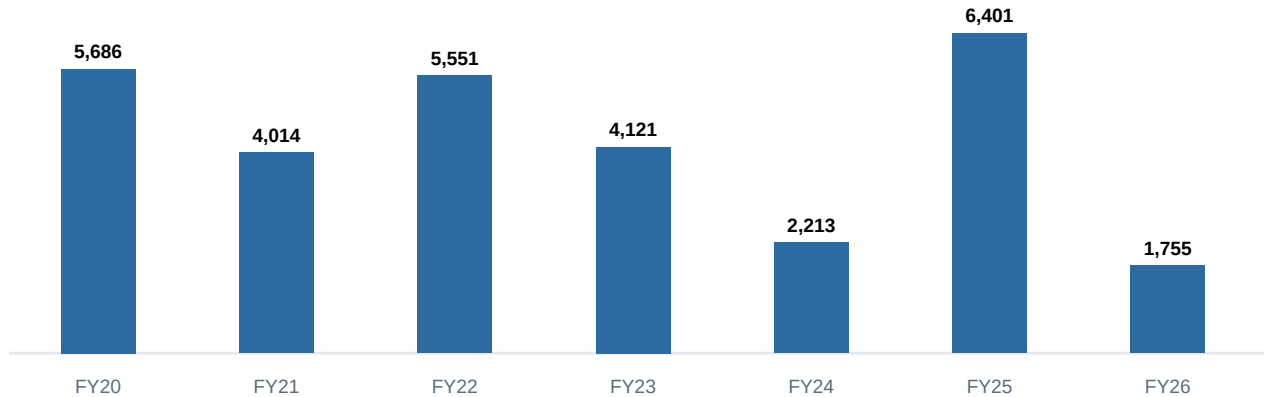


Figure 1 Annual recorded attendance

Fiscal year	Events	Attendance	Attendance per event	Program hours	Families served
FY20	122	5,686	46.6	138.8	374
FY21	109	4,014	36.8	276.5	1,809
FY22	76	5,551	73.0	367.0	1,209
FY23	58	4,121	71.1	243.0	1,499
FY24	53	2,213	41.8	273.2	563
FY25	78	6,401	82.1	271.8	626
FY26	66	1,755	26.6	363.5	690

Program interpretation

FY21 combined lower attendance with nearly twice as many recorded program hours as FY20. FY22 then produced 38 percent more attendance and 33 percent more hours than FY21 despite 30 percent fewer events. FY23 retained high attendance per event, but overall attendance fell as the number of events declined.

FY24 marked the lowest complete-year attendance in the series. FY25 reversed that pattern: attendance rose by 4,188 participants, while program hours remained almost unchanged. The program therefore reached substantially more people without a corresponding increase in recorded hours. Further review of event type and participant records would help identify which formats produced that gain.

The FY26 import added a much fuller operating record: 66 completed or reporting-complete events and 363.5 program hours through September 16. Average attendance is 26.6 participants per event, below the FY25 average of 82.1. The recorded family count of 690 already exceeds FY25. Those results may reflect smaller, longer activities and legitimate service patterns, but consistent definitions and duplicate-counting rules remain important.

Facebook activity and engagement

The Facebook archive contains 1,406 posts beginning in 2011. Posting increased gradually through 2015, reached a temporary high in 2020, declined during 2021 and 2022, and accelerated again during 2024 and 2025.

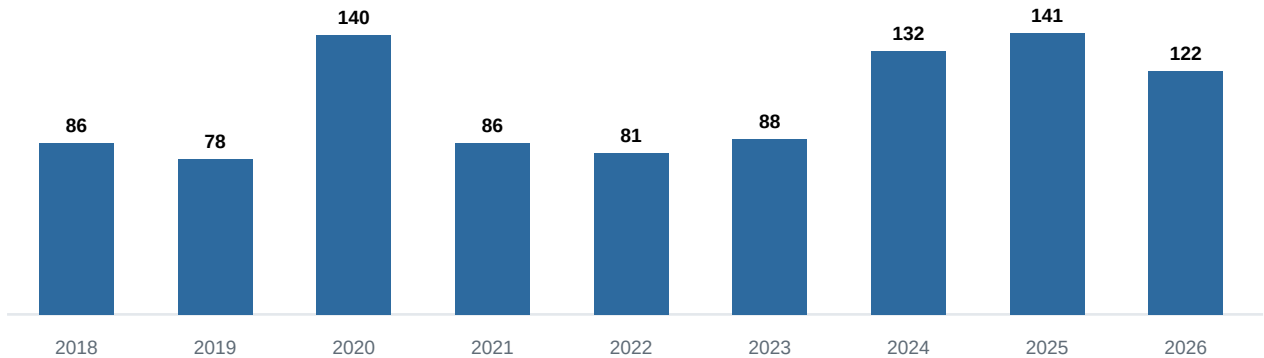


Figure 2 Facebook posts from 2018 through 2026

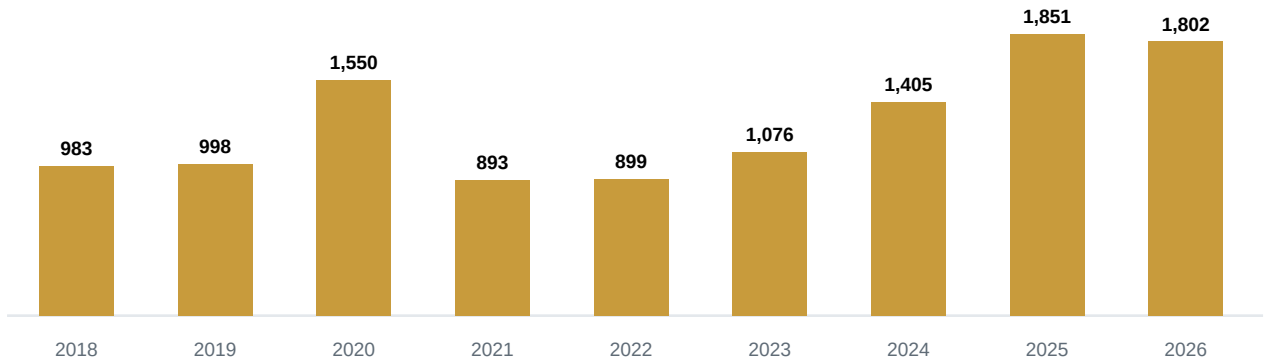


Figure 3 Recorded Facebook engagement from 2018 through 2026

The 2024 to 2025 comparison is the most useful completed-year signal. Posts rose from 132 to 141, while engagement rose from 1,405 to 1,851. Average engagement improved from 10.6 to 13.1 per post. This suggests stronger content performance, although the data does not identify a single cause.

The 2026 record is partial through September 16. At that point, engagement had nearly matched the 2025 annual total and average engagement had risen to 14.8 per post. If the remaining months follow a similar pattern, 2026 is positioned to exceed 2025, but this report does not project a final value.

Annual Facebook measures

Year	Posts	Engagement	Engagement per post	Recorded views
2011	6	9	1.5	0
2012	16	18	1.1	0
2013	61	33	0.5	2
2014	72	49	0.7	21
2015	110	112	1.0	3
2016	102	391	3.8	26
2017	85	536	6.3	72
2018	86	983	11.4	131
2019	78	998	12.8	145
2020	140	1,550	11.1	229
2021	86	893	10.4	465
2022	81	899	11.1	373
2023	88	1,076	12.2	1,674
2024	132	1,405	10.6	25,402
2025	141	1,851	13.1	130,441
2026	122	1,802	14.8	95,681

Follower growth

The reliable measured follower series begins in 2024. Followers increased from 1,693 at the end of 2024 to 1,763 at the end of 2025, a gain of 70. The page reached 1,834 followers by September 16, 2026, adding another 71 followers during the partial year.

Recorded views

Recorded views increased sharply from 1,674 in 2023 to 25,402 in 2024 and 130,441 in 2025. This series should not be used as a direct long-term growth comparison because Meta's historical metric availability changed. Recent view totals remain useful for current-period monitoring when the same collection method is used.

Management implications

The data supports four practical management priorities.

- **Compare the FY25 and FY26 event mix.** Review event categories, locations, delivery methods, duration, and audiences to explain why FY26 contains more hours but lower attendance.
- **Track reach per unit of effort.** Use attendance per event and attendance per program hour alongside total activity counts. This makes it easier to distinguish greater reach from greater workload.
- **Preserve recent communication practices.** Review the content and timing of the highest-engagement posts from 2025 and 2026, then use those patterns to guide future publishing.
- **Standardize reporting definitions.** Document how families served, participants, and program hours are counted. Consistent definitions will improve future year-over-year comparisons.

Interview discussion summary

The available data shows a program that achieved its strongest recorded attendance in FY25, followed by an FY26 schedule with more program hours but smaller average attendance. Recent digital engagement also improved. The next management opportunity is to connect those results with event types and content characteristics while strengthening data consistency. That analysis would support decisions about where to invest staff time, which activities to repeat, and how to demonstrate program reach.

Data scope and limitations

Program totals cover FY20 through FY26. The FY26 figures include 66 completed or reporting-complete events through September 16, 2026; the fiscal year has not yet ended. Raw database rows may also include cancelled or incomplete events that are excluded from the reporting total. Facebook post records cover January 2011 through September 16, 2026. Engagement totals reflect the metrics returned by the Meta Graph API. Historical reach is unavailable, and historical views are not consistently comparable. Follower snapshots before 2024 use the oldest available follower value and do not represent measured annual follower history. Historical Page Likes are unavailable through the current Meta API.

Family totals show large changes between years. The report preserves those recorded values but does not assume that the definition remained constant. Findings describe association and observed change; they do not establish causation.

Source

Iowa CYP administrative reporting records in Supabase, including annual program totals, activity logs, and Facebook page snapshots. Analysis current through September 16, 2026.